

and it provides for a very interesting and fresh first playthrough. However, after a few runs, the novelty did wear off, and we found ourselves enjoying the game's core sandbox modes better.

They also added tower defence elements for the final battles of the Rift segments, where you invest resources earned in battle to erect towers and walls and call in reinforcements. However, there are pre-decided locations where you can build them, you don't have a choice when it comes to where they go, and as such, it doesn't feel like they end up having too much of an impact in the grand scheme of things in the final battles.

The factions

Warhammer III has a few new factions for you to explore, including the new Chaos gods' factions and the Daemons of Chaos faction. Each of the Chaos gods have their own factions led by a powerful representative of the faction, however, the Daemons of Chaos, led by the corrupted Kislev prince, lets you recruit units from all Chaos factions. You also have access to each army's unique abilities, and the prince himself is customisable. The other Chaos factions, which feel somewhat limited in comparison, still have unique characteristics that help them stand out and affect the map in unique ways.

You also have the Kislev faction and the Grand Cathay. Kislev is all about ice magic and thunder bears. While Grand Cathay's leaders are literal dragons who can shapeshift in the middle of battle. There's also the Ogre kingdoms, who are part of the pre-order DLC.

Diplomacy – Never been easier to make friends, or start a war

There's been some QoL changes to diplomacy with Warhammer III. This includes the quick deal option, which allows you to quickly figure out which factions are open to actually dealing with you, instead of going through all of them one by one. Then there's the outposts. Forming an alliance allows you to construct outposts, which allows allies to garrison their troops. This allows for



MOAR!

DEVELOPERS

Creative Assembly,
Feral Interactive

PUBLISHERS

Feral Interactive, Sega

PLATFORMS

Microsoft Windows,
macOS, Linux,
Macintosh operating
systems

PLAYED ON

Microsoft Windows

PRICE

₹3,399 (Steam)

you to recruit troops from allied factions, making for an interesting way to round out your army composition. What's more, troops recruited from allies don't count towards your own recruitment cap. Thanks to the advantages of diplomacy this time around, you're encouraged to use it more often. Reinforcements cost Allegiance, which can be earned by helping allied factions, which is usually by defeating armies of their opposed factions.

Multiplayer

You now have simultaneous turns in multiplayer, allowing for players to move and take non-combat actions without needing to wait for other players to finish their turns. When a player gets into combat, the game pauses for everyone else and they can watch the action unfold. Unless they auto-resolve. Which has also been balanced a bit.

Post release performance issues

It would seem that the build reviewers

played the game on, and the game build that actually released were optimised differently. There have been complaints about the game's performance, even on high-end rigs. We played the version on the Xbox App, and didn't encounter too many FPS issues, but we did see plenty of dips and can't say that the performance was consistent throughout on our AMD RX 6600.

A fitting conclusion

Total War games can be confusing, especially for those who've never played them. There's a lot going on in Total War: Warhammer III, and it can be overwhelming for newcomers, but the tutorial does a decent job of teaching you the ropes. Still, Total War: Warhammer III is a great conclusion to the trilogy, with the best part being it's not over yet. The new mega-campaign expansion, Immortal Empires, will merge all three games into one. All the factions from every Warhammer game so far, on a single massive map. If that doesn't excite you, we don't know what will. *